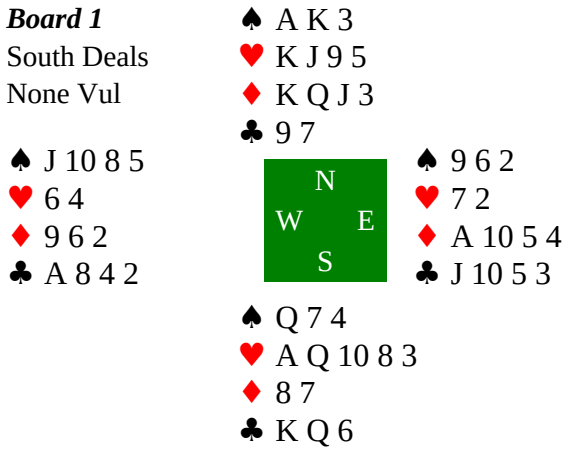
Board 1
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

5♥ by South
Lead: ♠J

Partner's bid is game forcing. With a bare minimum, no singletons, you go ahead and sign off in game. Partner then says 4♠.

Partner is definitely showing slam interest. If you had a first round control in either Minor suit you would bid it now. But you don't. So you sign of again, this time at 5♥. Partner finally gives up on the idea of slam and passes.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K Q J 4 2 ♥ — ♦ 9 7 5 3 ♣ K Q 8 4	
♠ 10 ♥ A K J 10 7 2 ♦ 6 4 ♣ 9 7 6 5		♠ 6 ♥ Q 8 6 4 3 ♦ A 8 2 ♣ J 10 3 2
	♠ A 9 8 7 5 3 ♥ 9 5 ♦ K Q J 10 ♣ A	

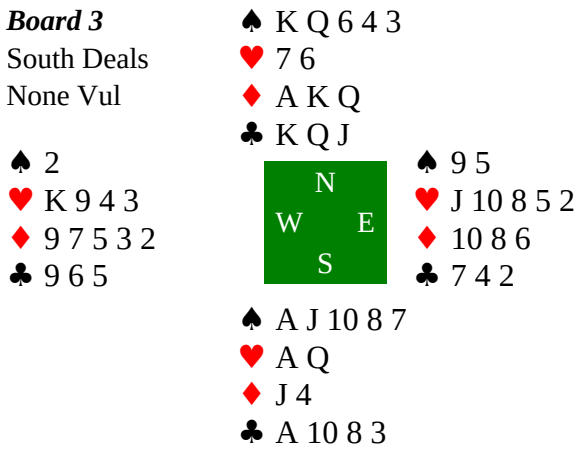
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	4♥	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

You want to force partner to game while you describe your hand. So you make a Splinter Bid of 4♥. Partner replies 5♣.

Partner has the ♣A. Good. You are pretty worried about ♦s and also your 11 high card points. You are tempted to just sign off at 5♠ but you shouldn't. You can make a control-bid below the 5♠ level. So you bid 5♥. This tells partner that your Splinter must have been a ♥ void. Partner bids 6♠.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♦	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7♠ by South
Lead: ♦2

With 17 points you need to indicate a better than minimum opening. You have no singletons and just a 5-card trump suit so you bid 3NT. Partner says 4♦ and it is your bid again.

Partner's 4♦ bid shows first round control (surely the Ace). You bid 4♥, showing your first round control. Partner now says 4NT.

You are being Blackwooded, and with three Aces you reply 5♠. That was apparently just what North wanted to hear, so he bid 7♠.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 9 6 ♥ K Q J 3 ♦ A Q 7 6 4 ♣ 10 2	
♠ A K Q 10 8 ♥ 9 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ J 8 5 4		♠ J 5 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 9 8 2 ♣ A 7 6 3
	♠ 7 4 3 ♥ A 10 8 5 2 ♦ K J ♣ K Q 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
1♠	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠K

You were all set to give a Jacoby 2NT response when West stuck in his 1♠ overcall. Now you can't because Jacoby is off after opponents interfere. Fortunately you have another bid at your disposal. You say 2♠, showing good ♥s and a limit raise or better. Partner bids 3♥.

Partner didn't have enough to bid game, not knowing if you had more than 11 points. But you know you have opening hand so you bid 4♥.